

# Chapter 8 — Villages, Towns and Trade

 **Sangam Age** ·  **Cities** ·  **The Silk Route** ·  **The Kushanas**

**The one-line point:** This chapter zooms out from kings to look at **who actually produced the wealth** — and then follows that wealth outward along the **Silk Route and the sea lanes to Rome**. ⚠️ **This is TWO old chapters merged into one, so it's the densest chapter in the book. Budget extra time.**

← Ch.7 | Index | Next: Ch.9 →

## Syllabus Classification

| Field                | Value                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Subject              | History → <b>Ancient India</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Sub-discipline       | <b>Socio-Economic History</b> + <b>Sangam Age (South India)</b> + <b>Post-Mauryan / Kushana period</b>                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Period               | ~300 BCE – 300 CE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Prelims (GS Paper I) | <i>History of India</i> → Sangam literature, trade routes, Kushanas, guilds, ports                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Mains (GS Paper I)   | ★ ★ <i>Indian culture</i> : Sangam literature; <b>Gandhara vs Mathura schools</b> of art; Buddhist spread. Also <b>Indian Society</b> (social stratification)                                                                                                                             |
| Also feeds           | <b>Art &amp; Culture</b> ★ ★ ★ (Gandhara/Mathura/Amaravati schools, Sangam literature), <b>Economy</b> (guilds, trade, coinage), <b>Geography</b> (trade routes, ports, monsoon winds), <b>IR</b> ★ (the Silk Route — directly relevant to India–Central Asia policy and BRI discussions) |
| Weightage            | ★ ★ ★ ★ — high. <b>Sangam Age</b> and <b>Kushana-era art</b> are the two most-asked components                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Overlaps with        | Ch.10 (art & literature), Ch.6 (Buddhism's spread and split)                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

 **Ancient India** → **Socio-Economic** + **South India**. Note the two distinct halves. **The Sangam Age is the first serious appearance of South India in your syllabus** — and UPSC has a well-documented fondness for it.

## Learning Outcomes

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

- ☐ **Explain** the iron ploughshare and paddy transplantation, and their social consequences.
- ☐ **Name and rank** the social groups in Tamil villages (*vellalar*, *uzhavar*, *kadaisiyar/adimai*) and in northern villages (*gramabhojaka*, *grihapati*, *dasa karmakara*).
- ☐ **Describe** the **Sangam Age**: what the Sangams were, the texts, the three kingdoms and their capitals/ports/emblems.
- ☐ **Explain** the **tinai** (eco-zone) classification of Sangam poetry.
- ☐ **Describe** the archaeology of towns: **ring wells**, **NBPW**, punch-marked coins.
- ☐ **Explain** what a **shreni (guild)** was and the range of functions it performed.
- ☐ **Describe Arikamedu** and the specific Roman evidence found there.

- ☐ **Trace** the **Silk Route** — its cargo, its routes, and its consequences.
- ☐ **Explain** **Hippalus** and the monsoon-wind discovery, and why it transformed trade.
- ☐ **Describe** the **Kushanas** and **Kanishka** — era, capitals, coins, Fourth Council, court figures.
- ☐ **Compare** the **Gandhara** and **Mathura** schools of art.
- ☐ **Name** the Chinese pilgrims and what each came for.
- ☐ **Explain** the rise of **Bhakti** and the arrival of **Christianity** in India.



## Start Here: The Question NCERT Is Really Asking

Chapters 5 and 7 were about kings, wars and empires. This chapter asks the question that actually matters:

**The king collected 1/6 of the produce. Fine — but WHO GREW IT?**

THE PYRAMID NOBODY CARVED INTO A PILLAR

KING

officials, priests

merchants, artisans, guilds

LARGE LANDOWNERS (vellalar / gramabhojaka)

SMALL FARMERS who plough their own land (uzhavar)

LANDLESS LABOURERS & SLAVES (kadasaiyar, adimai, dasa karmakara) — THEY DID THE ACTUAL WORK and appear in the record almost only as a category

Every edict, every pillar, every prashasti was made possible by the bottom two rows — and describes the top two.



**This is the "who got left out" thread from the index, in its most concrete form.** Chapter 1 told you records were made by the powerful; this chapter is NCERT quietly restoring the people those records omitted. **It is the single best chapter in the book for Mains social-history content.**



## The Software Engineer's Analogy

The Silk Route was **the ancient world's internet backbone** — and, exactly like the internet, its most important cargo turned out not to be the goods.

| WHAT MOVED ON THE ROUTE                                                                                                                                                | WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGED HISTORY                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Silk, spices, gold, glass → ivory, horses, muslin                                                                                                                      | Made merchants rich. Economically significant.                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| IDEAS<br>• BUDDHISM travelled to China, Korea, Japan<br>• Art styles (Greek → Gandhara → Central Asia → China)<br>• Mathematics, astronomy<br>• Technologies, diseases | → RESHAPED HALF THE WORLD.<br>Buddhism reached China, Korea, Japan along this route and is still there 2,000 years later. Gandhara's Greco-Buddhist style shaped East Asian Buddha images. Indian numerals eventually reached Europe via the Arabs. |
| ALSO: plague travelled the same route. Connectivity is never one-directional and never purely beneficial.                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

🔑 **The point worth carrying into an answer:** the Silk Route's lasting legacy was **cultural, not commercial**. The silk was consumed and gone; the ideas compounded for two millennia. **Trade routes are idea routes.** (And note the honest caveat — the same network carried disease. That balance makes a better answer than pure celebration.)

🌐 **Live IR relevance:** China's Belt and Road Initiative explicitly invokes Silk Route imagery. India's counter-narratives emphasise the **maritime** routes and Indian Ocean connectivity, and the **Buddhist Circuit** as cultural diplomacy. **Knowing the historical route well gives you a genuine edge in GS2/IR answers on connectivity.**

## PART A — 🏡 VILLAGES: Who Produced the Wealth

### 1 The Technology That Made Surplus Possible

Two innovations, already met in Chapter 5, deserve restating because everything here rests on them:

| Innovation                      | Effect                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Iron ploughshare</b> ★       | Turned over the heavy, clayey alluvial soil of the Ganga valley that wooden ploughs couldn't break.<br><b>Much higher yields</b>              |
| <b>Paddy transplantation</b> ★★ | Saplings grown in a nursery, then <b>transplanted</b> into flooded fields. Dramatically increases yield — <b>but requires enormous labour</b> |
| <b>Irrigation</b> ★             | Canals, wells, tanks and <b>artificial lakes</b> . Kings and rich landowners funded these — and gained prestige and control by doing so       |

⚠️ **NCERT's crucial rider, and the reason this chapter matters:** the yield gains from transplantation were captured by landowners, while the **labour** was supplied by **slaves and landless labourers who received no share of the increase**. Technological progress **widened** inequality rather than reducing it. **That's a genuinely strong, evidence-based line for Mains and Essay.**

## 2 Who Lived in a Village — Learn Both Regions

### 🌳 In the TAMIL region (South) ★★

| Group                   | Who they were                                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| VELLALAR ★              | <b>Large landowners</b> — the dominant landholding class              |
| UZHAVAR ★               | <b>Ploughmen</b> — ordinary cultivators who worked their own land     |
| KADAISIYAR and ADIMAI ★ | <b>Landless labourers, including slaves</b> — the bottom of the order |

### 🌳 In the NORTHERN region ★★

| Group            | Who they were                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GRAMA BHOJAKA ★★ | <b>The village headman.</b> Usually the <b>largest landowner</b> ; the post was often <b>HEREDITARY</b> ★. He had slaves and hired workers to cultivate his land; the king used him to <b>collect taxes</b> ; he also functioned as <b>judge</b> and sometimes <b>policeman</b> |
| GRIHAPATI ★      | <b>Independent farmers</b> — smaller landowners who cultivated their own land                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| DASA KARMAKARA ★ | <b>Slaves and hired workers</b> — landless, working others' fields for wages or as bondsmen                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Artisans         | Blacksmith, potter, carpenter, weaver — village craftspeople                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

★ **The *grama bhojaka* is the key figure to understand.** Look at the roles he combined: **biggest landowner + tax collector + judge + policeman**, and the position was **hereditary**. That is enormous concentrated local power — economic, fiscal, judicial and coercive, all in one hereditary office.

📖 **He's the single point of contact between the state and the village — and he holds all four capabilities with no separation of concerns and no rotation.** The state gained cheap reach; the village gained an unchallengeable local authority. **This is the deep historical root of rural power structures that Indian land reform and Panchayati Raj legislation have been trying to unpick ever since.**

🔗 **Cross-link to your Polity notes:** the 73rd Amendment's design — elected panchayats, reservation of seats, a separate State Election Commission — is in part a deliberate answer to exactly this hereditary-headman concentration. **A great connective point for a GS2 answer.**

## 3 📖 The SANGAM AGE — South India Enters the Syllabus

High-yield. UPSC asks about the Sangam Age regularly, and most aspirants under-prepare it.

### What were the Sangams?

**Sangam** = an **assembly/academy of Tamil poets**, traditionally held under the patronage of the **Pandya kings at Madurai**. Tradition speaks of **three Sangams**; the literature of the **third** largely survives.

| Aspect   | Detail                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Period   | c. 300 BCE – 300 CE                                                                                                                                                          |
| Language | Tamil                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Patrons  | The <b>Pandyas</b> of <b>Madurai</b>                                                                                                                                         |
| Nature   | Overwhelmingly <b>secular</b> poetry — about love, war, kings, ethics and everyday life. <b>Not primarily religious</b> , unlike most contemporary north Indian literature ★ |
| Authors  | ~473 poets, including ~30 women poets ★ — most famously <b>AVVAIYAR</b>                                                                                                      |

### The literature ★★

| Work               | Detail                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ettuthogai         | "The Eight Anthologies"                                                                                                                                                 |
| Pattuppattu        | "The Ten Idylls"                                                                                                                                                        |
| Tolkappiyam ★★     | <b>The earliest Tamil grammar</b> — by <b>Tolkappiyar</b> ; also covers poetics and sociology. <b>The oldest extant Tamil work</b>                                      |
| Pathinenkilkanakku | "The Eighteen Minor Works" — includes the <b>Tirukkural</b>                                                                                                             |
| TIRUKKURAL ★★      | By <b>THIRUVALLUVAR</b> — 1,330 couplets on ethics, polity and love. Often called the "Tamil Veda"; a universal ethical classic. ★ <b>Excellent GS4 Ethics citation</b> |
| Silappadikaram ★★  | By <b>ILANGO ADIGAL</b> — "The Tale of the Anklet"; the story of Kovalan, Kannagi and Madhavi. One of the <b>five great Tamil epics</b>                                 |
| Manimekalai ★★     | By <b>SATTANAR (Sittalai Sattanar)</b> — sequel to <i>Silappadikaram</i> , strongly <b>Buddhist</b> in outlook                                                          |

⚠ **Note:** *Silappadikaram* and *Manimekalai* are strictly **post-Sangam** (c. 5th–6th century CE), but are universally taught alongside Sangam literature and asked together. **Know the author-work pairs — that's the most common question format.**

### 🗡 The three Sangam kingdoms — "Muvendar" ★★★

| THE THREE CROWNED KINGS OF TAMILAKAM (MUVENDAR)   |                                                                                 |                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CHERA<br>(Kerala)                                 | CHOLA<br>(Coromandel/<br>Thanjavur)                                             | PANDYA<br>(Madurai region)                                                      |
| Capital:<br>* VANJI<br>(Karur)                    | Capital:<br>* URAIYUR                                                           | Capital:<br>* MADURAI                                                           |
| Port:<br>MUZIRIS<br>(Muchiri)                     | Port:<br>PUHAR /<br>KAVERIPATTINAM                                              | Port:<br>KORKAI<br>(famous for PEARLS)                                          |
| Emblem:<br>BOW                                    | Emblem:<br>TIGER                                                                | Emblem:<br>FISH (carp)                                                          |
| Famous ruler:<br>SENGUTTUVAN<br>(the "Red Chera") | Famous ruler:<br>KARIKALA<br>(Battle of Venni; built the Kallanai/Grand Anicut) | Famous ruler:<br>NEDUNJELIYAN<br><br>Patrons of the SANGAM academies at Madurai |

🗨️ **Memory hook for the emblems: "Chera-BOW, Chola-TIGER, Pandya-FISH."** Say it three times. It's a stock matching question.

**Capitals: "Chera-Vanji, Chola-Uraiyur, Pandya-Madurai."** Ports: **"Muziris, Puhar, Korkai."**

★ **KARIKALA CHOLA** deserves a line of his own: he won the **Battle of Venni**, founded **Puhar/Kaveripattinam**, and built the **Kallanai (Grand Anicut)** across the Kaveri — **one of the oldest water-diversion structures still in use anywhere in the world**. That's a superb, specific example for an Economy/Geography answer on ancient irrigation.

### 🌄 The *Tinai* system — Sangam poetry's eco-zones ★

A genuinely distinctive idea: Sangam poetry classifies landscapes into **five *tinai***, each with its own deity, people, occupation and associated emotional theme.

| Tinai           | Landscape           | Deity          | People/occupation       | Love-theme           |
|-----------------|---------------------|----------------|-------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>Kurinji</b>  | Hills/mountains     | Murugan        | Hunters, gatherers      | Union of lovers      |
| <b>Mullai</b>   | Forest/pastoral     | Mayon (Vishnu) | Herders                 | Patient waiting      |
| <b>Marutham</b> | Agricultural plains | Indra          | Farmers                 | Lovers' quarrels     |
| <b>Neithal</b>  | Coastal             | Varunan        | Fisherfolk, salt makers | Pining/separation    |
| <b>Palai</b>    | Arid/desert         | Kotravai       | Robbers, wanderers      | Separation, hardship |

**Poems also split by theme: *Aham*** (interior — love and personal life) and ***Puram*** (exterior — war, kings, public life).

🎯 **This is genuinely sophisticated literary architecture** — an ecological classification mapped onto emotional states. **It's a strong Art & Culture point** showing that ancient Indian literary theory was systematic, not merely devotional.

## PART B — 🏙️ TOWNS AND TRADE

### 4 The Archaeology of Towns

#### 🔵 Ring wells ★

Rings of **baked clay arranged one on top of another**, sunk into the ground. Found in many settlements.

**Uses:** as **toilets/soak pits**, as **drains**, as **garbage dumps**, and (in some cases) as **wells**.

🎯 A modest artefact with outsized meaning: ring wells indicate **sanitation arrangements in ordinary households** — not palaces. It's archaeology speaking for people no text mentions.

## ♥ NBPW — Northern Black Polished Ware ★★

| Aspect              | Detail                                                                                                  |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What</b>         | A fine, <b>glossy black (sometimes steel-grey/silvery) pottery</b> with a distinctive lustrous surface  |
| <b>When</b>         | c. <b>700–200 BCE</b> — the classic marker of the <b>Second Urbanisation</b> and the Mauryan period     |
| <b>Where</b>        | Mainly the Ganga valley, but traded very widely                                                         |
| <b>Significance</b> | <b>A luxury/deluxe ware</b> — its wide distribution maps trade networks, and its presence dates a layer |

 **NBPW is the archaeologist's version-string.** Find it in a layer and you've dated the layer and identified it as connected to the Gangetic trade network. Chapter 2 told you pottery is archaeology's most useful fossil — **NBPW is the flagship example.**

## 🪙 Punch-marked coins ★

- India's **earliest coins**, mostly **silver** (some copper)
- Called **PANA** or **karshapana**
- Made by **punching symbols** (sun, wheel, hill, tree, animals) onto metal pieces — **no ruler's name or portrait** ★
- Circulated from ~600 BCE, becoming widespread in the Mauryan period

 **Prelims trap:** punch-marked coins bear **symbols, not names or portraits**. The first coins with **rulers' names and portraits** in India come from the **Indo-Greeks**. **Kanishka's gold coins** later show him and various deities.

## 🏪 Shrenis — Guilds ★★

A **SHRENI** was an **association of craftspersons or merchants** — the corporate backbone of the ancient Indian economy.

**What a shreni actually did:**

| Function                             | Detail                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Trained craftspersons</b>         | Apprenticeship and skill transmission                                                                                                               |
| <b>Procured raw material</b>         | Bulk purchase and supply                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Distributed finished products</b> | Marketing and sale                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Set standards</b>                 | Quality and price regulation for the trade                                                                                                          |
| <b>Acted as BANKS</b> ★              | Received deposits from rich merchants and religious institutions and paid <b>interest</b> ; the corpus funded monasteries and temples in perpetuity |
| <b>Made religious donations</b> ★    | Guild donations are recorded in <b>inscriptions at Sanchi, Bharhut, Karle, Nasik and Amaravati</b> — a major source of evidence                     |
| <b>Self-regulation</b>               | Had their own rules, headmen and internal dispute resolution, often recognised by the state                                                         |

★ **The banking function deserves emphasis.** A donor could deposit a sum with a guild on the condition that the **interest** perpetually funded, say, lamps or robes for a monastery. **That is an endowment with a perpetual income stream — ancient India's version of a trust fund**, and it was legally durable enough that inscriptions record the terms.

🔗 **Guild inscriptions are also a source in the Chapter 1 sense** — they record artisans and merchants (weavers, oil-pressers, potters, ivory-carvers) by name and trade. **Non-royal people entering the historical record through their own donations.** Beautiful example for Mains.

## 🌐 Key cities

| City                            | Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mathura</b> ★ ★ ★            | At the junction of <b>two major routes</b> — the north-west route and the route to the Deccan. A great <b>trade, craft (textiles) and religious centre</b> ; the <b>second capital of the Kushanas</b> ★; a major <b>school of sculpture</b> ★; sacred to Krishna devotion; also an important Jain and Buddhist centre. <b>Numerous inscriptions record donations by ordinary people</b> |
| <b>Pataliputra</b>              | Mauryan capital; on the Ganga                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Varanasi</b>                 | Ancient centre of textiles and religion                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Taxila</b>                   | North-west; learning centre; on the Uttarapatha                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Ujjain</b>                   | Western India; junction of routes; astronomy centre                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Puhar / Kaveripattinam</b> ★ | Chola port; vividly described in <i>Silappadikaram</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Madurai</b>                  | Pandya capital; Sangam academies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Arikamedu</b> ★ ★ ★          | Near Puducherry — <b>the great Indo-Roman trading station</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Tamralipti</b>               | Bengal port on the eastern coast; departure point for Southeast Asia                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Bharuch (Barygaza)</b> ★     | The greatest port on the western coast                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Muziris (Pattanam)</b> ★     | Chera port in Kerala; enormous Roman coin finds                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

## 5 🚢 **ARIKAMEDU — The Roman Connection** ★ ★ ★

**Arikamedu, near Puducherry (Pondicherry), on the Ariyankuppam river** — occupied c. 1st century BCE – 2nd century CE. Excavated notably by **Mortimer Wheeler**.

**What was found there — learn this list, it's asked directly:**



| Find                                                           | Significance                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A massive brick structure</b> — possibly a <b>warehouse</b> | A trading depot, not just a village                                                            |
| <b>AMPHORAE</b> ★★                                             | Tall, double-handled <b>Roman jars</b> used to carry <b>wine and olive oil</b>                 |
| <b>ARRETINE WARE</b> ★★                                        | Stamped <b>red-glazed Roman pottery</b> , made in <b>Arezzo, Italy</b> — unmistakably imported |
| <b>ROULETTED WARE</b> ★                                        | Fine pottery with rouletted (wheel-impressed) decoration                                       |
| <b>Roman lamps, glassware, gems</b>                            | Roman luxury imports                                                                           |
| <b>Bead-making and dyeing facilities</b>                       | Local <b>production for export</b> — Arikamedu made goods <i>for</i> the Roman market          |
| <b>Roman coins</b>                                             | Direct evidence of the trade balance                                                           |

★ **The Tamil word YAVANA** was used for Greeks and then Romans/westerners generally. Sangam poems describe **yavanas arriving in ships, paying in gold, and taking away pepper** — and even mention yavanas employed as **bodyguards** by Tamil kings. **The literature and the archaeology corroborate each other precisely** — which is exactly the methodological ideal Chapter 1 set up.

### 💰 The Indo-Roman trade

**India exported:** ★ **PEPPER** (Romans called it "*black gold*" — the single biggest item), spices (cardamom, cinnamon, ginger), **muslin** and fine cotton textiles, **pearls** (from Korkai), **gemstones** (beryl from Coimbatore), ivory, **teak**, indigo, sandalwood, and **exotic animals**.

**India imported:** **GOLD and SILVER COINS** ★ (in enormous quantity), wine, olive oil, glassware, coral, some slaves, and lead/tin.

★★ **The trade balance was so heavily in India's favour** that the Roman writer **PLINY THE ELDER** complained that India was "**the sink of the world's gold**" — draining the Roman treasury of precious metal. **Huge hoards of Roman gold coins have been found in South India**, especially Tamil Nadu and Kerala, which archaeologically confirms Pliny's complaint.

🎯 **This is a fantastic fact.** It shows ancient India as a **major exporter of high-value manufactured and agricultural goods running a large trade surplus with the era's superpower**. It's quotable in Economy answers on India's historical trade position and in Essay on India's economic history.

### 🚢 Hippalus and the Monsoon ★★

Around the **1st century CE**, a Greek sailor named **HIPPALUS** is credited (in Greco-Roman sources) with recognising the **regularity of the monsoon winds** across the Arabian Sea.

#### BEFORE

Ships hugged the coastline, creeping around Arabia and Persia. Slow, dangerous, many months, many middlemen.

#### AFTER

Ships sailed **DIRECT** across the open Arabian Sea:  
 • SW monsoon (summer) → to India  
 • NE monsoon (winter) → back

~40 DAYS instead of many months.  
 Middlemen bypassed. Volume soars.



**This is a latency-and-hop-count optimisation.** He didn't invent a new ship — he discovered that a *predictable* natural pattern let you take a direct route instead of many short hops through intermediaries. **Fewer hops, lower latency, no rent-seeking middlemen, dramatically higher throughput.** Indo-Roman trade volume exploded as a direct result.

**Also know:** the *Periplus of the Erythraean Sea* ★ — an anonymous Greek merchant's handbook (1st century CE) listing Indian Ocean ports, goods and sailing conditions. **A superb primary source** for ancient Indian trade.

6

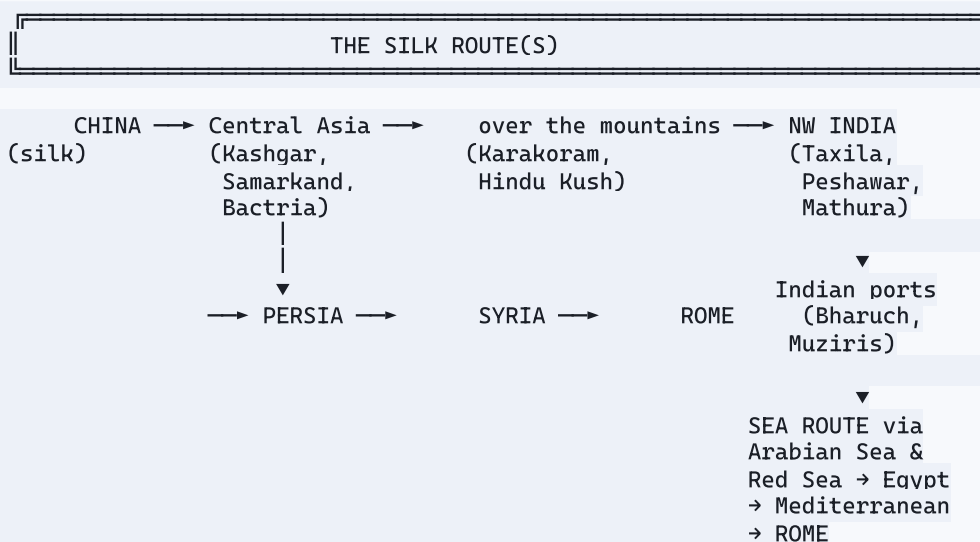


## THE SILK ROUTE

### The commodity

**Silk** was made in **China**, which guarded the secret of sericulture (silkworm rearing) fiercely for centuries. Roman elites paid extraordinary prices for it — so much so that the Roman Senate periodically tried to ban it as a drain on the treasury and an affront to modesty.

### The route



THE CRUCIAL POINT: a long stretch of the overland route passed through NORTH-WESTERN INDIA. Whoever controlled that stretch collected the TAXES on everything moving along it.

→ THE KUSHANAS controlled it. → THE KUSHANAS GOT VERY RICH.  
→ Which is why Kanishka's coins are GOLD.

**Also travelling the route:** horses (from Central Asia — always in demand in India), glass, gold, gems, spices, and — most consequentially — **Buddhism, art styles, mathematics and astronomy.**



**Buddhism travelled the Silk Route** with merchants and monks into Central Asia, then **China, Korea and Japan**. Monasteries were established along the route as **rest stops for traders** — a symbiosis in which merchants funded monasteries and monasteries provided safe lodging, credit and legitimacy. **The Bamiyan Buddhas** in Afghanistan (destroyed 2001) stood on this route.

## 7 🏰 THE KUSHANAS AND KANISHKA

| Aspect                             | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Origin</b>                      | A branch of the <b>Yuezhi</b> , a Central Asian people                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Empire</b>                      | Central Asia and north-west India — Afghanistan, Pakistan, north India down to the Ganga valley                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Two capitals</b><br>★ ★         | <b>PESHAWAR (Purushapura)</b> and <b>MATHURA</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Greatest ruler</b>              | <b>KANISHKA</b> ★ ★ ★                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Era</b> ★ ★                     | Kanishka began the <b>SAKA ERA in 78 CE</b> — ★ <b>this is INDIA'S NATIONAL CALENDAR (the Saka Samvat), adopted 22 March 1957</b> ★                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Religion</b>                    | Patronised <b>Buddhism</b> (especially <b>Mahayana</b> ); his coins also show Greek, Persian, Zoroastrian and Indian deities — an eclectic, cosmopolitan pantheon                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Fourth Buddhist Council</b> ★ ★ | Convened by Kanishka in <b>Kashmir (Kundalvana)</b> ; presided over by <b>Vasumitra</b> ; <b>Ashvaghosha</b> as deputy; Buddhism split formally into <b>Hinayana and Mahayana</b> ; texts compiled in <b>Sanskrit</b>                                                                                                 |
| <b>Coins</b> ★                     | <b>GOLD</b> coins of high purity, bearing his image and a wide range of deities — evidence of enormous trade wealth                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Court figures</b><br>★ ★        | <b>ASHVAGHOSHA</b> (poet; wrote <i>Buddhacharita</i> , a life of the Buddha, and <i>Saundarananda</i> ), <b>CHARAKA</b> (the great physician; <i>Charaka Samhita</i> ), <b>NAGARJUNA</b> (Mahayana philosopher; founder of the <i>Madhyamaka</i> /Shunyavada school), <b>VASUMITRA</b> , <b>Sushruta</b> (associated) |
| <b>Earlier Kushana</b>             | <b>Kujula Kadphises</b> , <b>Vima Kadphises</b> (first to issue gold coins)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

★ ★ **The Saka era = India's national calendar** is a genuinely high-value cross-syllabus fact (History → Polity → General Awareness). India's official calendar, used in the *Gazette of India* and by All India Radio, is the **Saka Samvat**, whose year 1 is **78 CE** — the era conventionally associated with Kanishka. **Adopted alongside the Gregorian calendar on 22 March 1957.**

### 🎨 Gandhara vs Mathura — The Art & Culture Comparison ★ ★ ★

Under the Kushanas, the **first images of the Buddha in human form** were made (ending the aniconic phase of Chapter 6). Two schools emerged, and **comparing them is a standard question.**

|                      | GANDHARA SCHOOL                                                                        | MATHURA SCHOOL                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Region</b>        | North-west (Taxila, Peshawar, Swat, Afghanistan)                                       | <b>Mathura</b> , UP                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Influence</b>     | ★ <b>GRECO-ROMAN (Hellenistic)</b> — hence "Greco-Buddhist"                            | ★ <b>INDIGENOUS Indian</b> — descended from yaksha figures                                                                                          |
| <b>Material</b>      | <b>Grey/blue-grey schist</b> (and stucco)                                              | ★ <b>Spotted RED SANDSTONE</b> (from Sikri)                                                                                                         |
| <b>Buddha's face</b> | Sharp, <b>Apollo-like</b> features; wavy hair; moustache sometimes                     | Rounder, fuller, <b>smiling</b> ; shaven head or <i>ushnisha</i>                                                                                    |
| <b>Drapery</b>       | <b>Thick, heavy, with realistic folds</b> (like a Roman toga), covering both shoulders | <b>Thin, clinging, transparent</b> , folds shown lightly; right shoulder often bare                                                                 |
| <b>Mood</b>          | <b>Spiritual, meditative, calm</b>                                                     | <b>Energetic, robust, muscular, joyful</b>                                                                                                          |
| <b>Body</b>          | Anatomically naturalistic, muscular in a Greek idiom                                   | Broad-shouldered, powerful, less anatomically naturalistic                                                                                          |
| <b>Subjects</b>      | Mainly the <b>Buddha and Bodhisattvas</b>                                              | Buddha, <b>and also</b> Jain tirthankaras, Hindu deities, <b>yakshis</b> , and <b>royal portraits</b> (the famous headless <b>Kanishka statue</b> ) |
| <b>Patrons</b>       | Kushanas (esp. Kanishka), Shakas                                                       | Kushanas                                                                                                                                            |

★ **The third school to know: AMARAVATI** (Andhra Pradesh, on the Krishna; under the **Satavahanas**). **White marble/limestone**; narrative relief panels teeming with slender, dynamic, expressive figures; **Jataka stories** in stone. It influenced **Sri Lankan and Southeast Asian art**.

🟡 **Three-way hook: "Gandhara = GREY schist + GREEK. Mathura = RED sandstone + INDIGENOUS. Amaravati = WHITE marble + NARRATIVE."** Colour-code them; it works.

### The Satavahanas (worth knowing alongside)

- Ruled the **Deccan** (c. 1st century BCE – 2nd century CE); capital **Pratishthana (Paithan)**
- Greatest ruler: **Gautamiputra Satakarni** ★ — known from the **Nasik prashasti** issued by his mother **Gautami Balashri**
- Patronised **Buddhism** — the **Amaravati** stupa and the **Karle, Bhaja, Nasik** cave complexes
- ★ Notable for **matronymics** (kings named after their mothers — *Gautamiputra, Vasishthiputra*), which is socially significant and often asked

## 8 🧑 The Chinese Pilgrims ★★

Three Chinese Buddhist monks travelled to India and left invaluable accounts. **Learn who came when and under whom.**

| Pilgrim                            | When                 | Ruler in India                 | Came for                                | Wrote                                                      |
|------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FA XIAN (Fa-Hien)</b> ★★        | <b>c. 399–414 CE</b> | <b>Chandragupta II</b> (Gupta) | Buddhist texts, esp. the <b>Vinaya</b>  | <i>Fo-Kuo-Ki</i> ("Record of Buddhist Kingdoms")           |
| <b>XUAN ZANG (Hiuen Tsang)</b> ★★★ | <b>c. 630–645 CE</b> | <b>Harshavardhana</b>          | Study at <b>Nalanda</b> ; collect texts | <i>Si-Yu-Ki</i> ("Records of the Western World")           |
| <b>I-TSING (Yijing)</b> ★          | <b>c. 671–695 CE</b> | Post-Harsha                    | Study at <b>Nalanda</b>                 | Accounts of Buddhist practice in India and the archipelago |

★ **Xuan Zang is the most important.** He studied at **Nalanda** for years under **Shilabhadra**, travelled the length of India, and his account is our single richest description of 7th-century India — cities, roads, monasteries, customs, and Harsha's administration. He is the basis of the Chinese classic *Journey to the West*.

🎯 **A Chapter 1 callback:** these are **foreign literary sources** — outsiders describing India, so they notice what insiders take for granted. **But they were Buddhist monks**, so they emphasise Buddhism and may understate the vitality of other traditions. **Naming that bias in a Mains answer shows source-criticism.**

## 9 🧑 New Religious Developments

### The rise of BHAKTI ★★

Alongside all this trade and empire, a major religious shift was underway.

| Aspect                 | Detail                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bhakti</b>          | <b>Devotion</b> — a personal, loving, direct relationship between devotee and deity                                                          |
| <b>The key idea</b> ★  | <b>No priest, no elaborate ritual, no sacrifice, and NO BARRIER OF CASTE OR GENDER</b> is needed. The devotee approaches the deity directly  |
| <b>Deities</b>         | <b>Shiva, Vishnu</b> (and his incarnations, esp. <b>Krishna</b> and <b>Rama</b> ), and goddesses — <b>Durga</b> and other forms of the Devi  |
| <b>Key text</b> ★ ★    | The <b>BHAGAVAD GITA</b> (part of the <i>Mahabharata</i> ) — Krishna teaches Arjuna that devotion and duty, rather than ritual, are the path |
| <b>Consequence</b> ★   | <b>TEMPLES</b> and <b>IMAGES</b> become central to worship (rather than the fire altar). This drives the temple architecture of Ch.9–10      |
| <b>Later flowering</b> | The <b>Alvars</b> (Vishnu) and <b>Nayanars</b> (Shiva) in Tamil country from ~6th century CE, and then the great medieval Bhakti movement    |

🎯 **Why Bhakti mattered socially:** it offered spiritual access to those excluded by Vedic ritual — **women and lower castes could be devotees**, and some became celebrated saints. It's a recurring GS1 theme (social reform through religion) and connects forward to the medieval Bhakti-Sufi movements. **Also note it's part of the answer to "why did Buddhism decline" (Ch.6) — Bhakti offered comparable accessibility from within the Hindu fold.**

### 🏠 Christianity arrives ★

- Tradition holds that **St Thomas the Apostle** arrived on the **Malabar coast (Kerala)** around **52 CE**, establishing Christian communities
- The **Syrian Christians / St Thomas Christians** of Kerala trace their origin to this
- ★ **The route was the trade route** — Christianity reached India by the same sea lanes that carried pepper to Rome

🎯 **A neat, high-value observation:** India had Christian communities **centuries before most of Europe was Christianised**. It's a strong point for answers on India's religious pluralism and its ancient cosmopolitan connections. **Judaism (the Cochin Jews) and later Islam and Zoroastrianism (Parsis) arrived along the same Malabar trade routes.**

### 🙏 Also in this period

- **Hinduism** as we recognise it takes shape — image worship, temples, the Puranas being compiled
- **Mahayana Buddhism** develops the **Bodhisattva** ideal and Buddha images (Ch.6)
- Buddhism and Jainism continue to receive **merchant and guild patronage** — inscriptions at Sanchi, Bharhut, Karle and Amaravati record donations by traders, artisans and their guilds

## Prelims

| Topic                                   | The exact thing to know                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tamil village groups</b> ★★          | <b>Vellalar</b> (large landowners), <b>uzhavar</b> (ploughmen), <b>kadaisiyar/adimai</b> (landless/slaves)                                                               |
| <b>North village groups</b> ★★          | <b>Grama bhojaka</b> (headman, hereditary, largest landowner, tax collector, judge), <b>grihapati</b> (small farmer), <b>dasa karmakara</b> (slaves/hired workers)       |
| <b>Sangam kingdoms</b> ★★ ★             | <b>Chera</b> –Vanji–Muziris– <b>bow</b> ; <b>Chola</b> –Uraiyur–Puhar– <b>tiger</b> ; <b>Pandya</b> –Madurai–Korkai– <b>fish</b>                                         |
| <b>Sangam works &amp; authors</b> ★★ ★  | <i>Tolkappiyam</i> – <b>Tolkappiyar</b> ; <i>Tirukkural</i> – <b>Thiruvalluvar</b> ; <i>Silappadikaram</i> – <b>Ilango Adigal</b> ; <i>Manimekalai</i> – <b>Sattanar</b> |
| <b>Avvaiyar</b>                         | The most famous woman Sangam poet                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Tinai</b> ★                          | Five eco-zones: Kurinji, Mullai, Marutham, Neithal, Palai                                                                                                                |
| <b>Karikala Chola</b> ★                 | Battle of <b>Venni</b> ; built the <b>Kallanai (Grand Anicut)</b>                                                                                                        |
| <b>Ring wells</b>                       | Toilets, drains, garbage pits, wells                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>NBPW</b> ★★                          | Northern Black Polished Ware — Second Urbanisation / Mauryan marker                                                                                                      |
| <b>Punch-marked coins</b> ★             | Silver; <b>symbols, not names or portraits</b>                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Shreni</b> ★★                        | Guild — training, procurement, standards, <b>banking</b> , donations                                                                                                     |
| <b>Arikamedu</b> ★★ ★                   | <b>Amphorae, Arretine ware, rouletted ware</b> , Roman lamps, warehouse; near Puducherry                                                                                 |
| <b>Yavana</b>                           | Greeks/Romans/westerners in Tamil sources                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Pliny</b> ★                          | Called India " <b>the sink of the world's gold</b> "                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Hippalus</b> ★★                      | Monsoon winds → direct Arabian Sea crossing                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Periplus of the Erythraean Sea</b> ★ | Greek merchant's handbook of Indian Ocean trade                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Pepper</b>                           | Roman "black gold" — India's top export                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Kushana capitals</b> ★★              | <b>Peshawar (Purushapura)</b> and <b>Mathura</b>                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Saka era</b> ★★ ★                    | <b>78 CE</b> , begun by <b>Kanishka</b> ; <b>India's national calendar</b> (adopted 1957)                                                                                |
| <b>Fourth Buddhist Council</b> ★★       | <b>Kanishka, Kashmir, Vasumitra</b> ; Hinayana/Mahayana split; Sanskrit                                                                                                  |
| <b>Kanishka's court</b> ★★              | <b>Ashvaghosha</b> ( <i>Buddhacharita</i> ), <b>Charaka</b> ( <i>Charaka Samhita</i> ), <b>Nagarjuna</b> , Vasumitra                                                     |
| <b>Gandhara vs Mathura</b> ★★ ★         | Grey schist + Greco-Roman vs <b>red sandstone</b> + indigenous                                                                                                           |
| <b>Amaravati</b> ★                      | White marble/limestone; narrative; <b>Satavahana</b>                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Satavahanas</b> ★                    | <b>Gautamiputra Satakarni</b> ; <b>Nasik prashasti</b> by <b>Gautami Balashri</b> ; <b>matronymics</b>                                                                   |
| <b>Chinese pilgrims</b> ★★              | <b>Fa Xian</b> (Chandragupta II), <b>Xuan Zang</b> (Harsha), <b>I-Tsing</b>                                                                                              |
| <b>Bhakti</b> ★★                        | Personal devotion; <b>no priest, no caste barrier</b> ; <b>Bhagavad Gita</b>                                                                                             |
| <b>St Thomas</b> ★                      | <b>Kerala, c. 52 CE</b>                                                                                                                                                  |

## Traps:

- "**Punch-marked coins bear the king's portrait**" → **FALSE**. Symbols only
- "**Kanishka convened the Third Buddhist Council**" → **FALSE**. The **Fourth**; the Third was Ashoka's

- "Gandhara art used red sandstone" → **FALSE**. That's **Mathura**. Gandhara used **grey schist**
- "The Saka era began in 58 BCE" → **FALSE**. That's the **Vikrama Samvat**. **Saka = 78 CE**
- "Sangam literature is primarily religious" → **FALSE**. Predominantly **secular**
- "Silappadikaram was written by Sattanar" → **FALSE**. **Ilango Adigal**; Sattanar wrote *Manimekalai*
- "Xuan Zang visited during Chandragupta II's reign" → **FALSE**. That was **Fa Xian**; Xuan Zang came under **Harsha**

## Mains

- **Art & Culture** ★ ★ ★ : *"Compare and contrast the Gandhara and Mathura schools of art."* — a near-certainty at some point. Cover material, influence, drapery, expression, subject matter, patronage
  - **Art & Culture**: Sangam literature as a corpus — secular character, *tinai* system, *aham/puram*, women poets, the *Tirukkural*
  - **Economy/IR** ★ : *"Discuss the significance of the Silk Route in the cultural and commercial history of India."* — and connect to contemporary connectivity debates
  - **Society** ★ : *"Technological change in early historic India increased production but deepened social inequality."* Use transplantation, the *grama bhojaka*, and *dasa karmakara*
  - **Ethics (GS4)**: the **Tirukkural** is an outstanding source of quotable ethical aphorisms
-

## Glossary

| Term                       | Meaning                                                                       |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Vellalar</b>            | Large landowners (Tamil)                                                      |
| <b>Uzhavar</b>             | Ploughmen/cultivators (Tamil)                                                 |
| <b>Kadaisiyar / Adimai</b> | Landless labourers and slaves (Tamil)                                         |
| <b>Grama bhojaka</b>       | Village headman (north) — hereditary, largest landowner, tax collector, judge |
| <b>Grihapati</b>           | Independent small farmer                                                      |
| <b>Dasa karmakara</b>      | Slaves and hired labourers                                                    |
| <b>Sangam</b>              | Assembly/academy of Tamil poets at Madurai                                    |
| <b>Tinai</b>               | The five eco-zones of Sangam poetry                                           |
| <b>Aham / Puram</b>        | Interior (love) / exterior (war, public life) themes                          |
| <b>Muvendar</b>            | The three crowned kings — Chera, Chola, Pandya                                |
| <b>Shreni</b>              | Guild of craftspersons or merchants                                           |
| <b>Ring well</b>           | Stacked baked-clay rings used as toilet, drain, pit or well                   |
| <b>NBPW</b>                | Northern Black Polished Ware                                                  |
| <b>Pana / Karshapana</b>   | Punch-marked coin                                                             |
| <b>Amphora</b>             | Roman two-handled jar for wine/oil                                            |
| <b>Arretine ware</b>       | Stamped red-glazed Roman pottery from Arezzo                                  |
| <b>Rouletted ware</b>      | Fine pottery with wheel-impressed decoration                                  |
| <b>Yavana</b>              | Greeks, later Romans/westerners                                               |
| <b>Periplus</b>            | A sailing handbook; here, the <i>Periplus of the Erythraean Sea</i>           |
| <b>Saka era</b>            | Era beginning 78 CE; India's national calendar                                |
| <b>Ushnisha</b>            | Cranial protuberance on Buddha images                                         |
| <b>Bodhisattva</b>         | Being who defers nirvana to help others                                       |
| <b>Bhakti</b>              | Personal devotion to a deity                                                  |
| <b>Matronymic</b>          | Name derived from the mother (Satavahana practice)                            |
| <b>Prashasti</b>           | Eulogistic inscription praising a ruler                                       |

## 2-MINUTE RECAP

- Iron ploughshare + paddy transplantation + irrigation** produced surplus — but the gains went to landowners while the labour came from slaves and the landless. **Progress widened inequality.**
- Tamil villages: vellalar** (large landowners) → **uzhavar** (ploughmen) → **kadaisiyar/adimai** (landless/slaves).
- Northern villages: grama bhojaka** (hereditary headman — landowner + tax collector + judge + policeman), **grihapati**, **dasa karmakara**.
- Sangam Age (300 BCE–300 CE):** Tamil, **secular**, patronised by the **Pandys at Madurai**; ~473 poets including ~30 women (**Avvaiyar**).
- Texts:** *Tolkappiyam* (Tolkappiyar), *Tirukkural* (**Thiruvalluvar**), *Silappadikaram* (**Ilango Adigal**), *Manimekalai* (**Sattanar**).



6. **Three kingdoms: Chera** (Vanji, Muziris, **bow**), **Chola** (Uraiyur, Puhar, **tiger**), **Pandya** (Madurai, Korkai, **fish**). **Karikala Chola** built the **Kallanai**.
  7. **Tinai** — five poetic eco-zones; **aham/puram** thematic split.
  8. **Town archaeology: ring wells, NBPW, punch-marked coins** (symbols, no names).
  9. **Shrenis (guilds)** trained, procured, set standards, **acted as banks paying interest**, and made recorded donations — putting non-royal people into the historical record.
  10. **Arikamedu: amphorae, Arretine ware, rouletted ware**, warehouse, bead-making — the Indo-Roman trading station.
  11. **India exported pepper ("black gold"), muslin, pearls, gems; imported Roman GOLD. Pliny: India is "the sink of the world's gold."**
  12. **Hippalus** and the **monsoon winds** → direct Arabian Sea crossing → trade volume explodes. See the **Periplus**.
  13. **Silk Route** carried silk, horses, gems — **and Buddhism, art styles and mathematics** into Central Asia, China, Korea, Japan.
  14. **Kushanas** controlled the north-west stretch and grew rich. **Kanishka: capitals Peshawar and Mathura; Saka era 78 CE = India's national calendar; Fourth Buddhist Council** in Kashmir (Vasumitra) → Hinayana/Mahayana split; gold coins; court of **Ashvaghosha, Charaka, Nagarjuna**.
  15. **First Buddha images** appear now. **Gandhara** = grey schist, Greco-Roman, heavy folds, meditative. **Mathura** = **red sandstone**, indigenous, thin clinging drapery, energetic. **Amaravati** = white marble, narrative, Satavahana.
  16. **Satavahanas: Gautamiputra Satakarni, Nasik prashasti, matronymics**.
  17. **Chinese pilgrims: Fa Xian** (Chandragupta II), **Xuan Zang** (Harsha, Nalanda), **I-Tsing**.
  18. **Bhakti** rises — direct devotion, **no priest or caste barrier**, **Bhagavad Gita**, temples and images become central.
  19. **St Thomas** reaches **Kerala c. 52 CE** — Christianity arrives by the pepper route.
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## **Test Yourself**

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### **Prelims style**

1. Which of the following was found at Arikamedu?
  1. Amphorae
  2. Arretine ware
  3. Rouletted ware → *All three*.
2. Consider the following pairs:
  1. *Silappadikaram* — Ilango Adigal
  2. *Manimekalai* — Sattanar
  3. *Tirukkural* — Tolkappiyar → *1 and 2 only*. The *Tirukkural* is by **Thiruvalluvar**; Tolkappiyar wrote the *Tolkappiyam*.
3. The Saka era, used as India's national calendar, begins in — → *78 CE, associated with Kanishka. (The Vikrama Samvat begins 58 BCE.)*
4. With reference to the Gandhara school of art, which is/are correct?
  1. It used grey schist as its principal medium.
  2. It shows strong Hellenistic influence.

3. Its Buddha figures wear thin, clinging drapery. → *1 and 2 only. Thin clinging drapery characterises **Mathura**; Gandhara has heavy, realistic folds.*
5. The emblems of the Chera, Chola and Pandya were respectively — → *Bow, tiger and fish.*
6. Who among the following visited India during the reign of Harshavardhana? → *Xuan Zang. (Fa Xian came under Chandragupta II.)*

### **Mains style**

7. Compare and contrast the Gandhara and Mathura schools of art. **(250 words)**
8. "*The Silk Route's most enduring cargo was not silk but ideas.*" Discuss with reference to India. **(250 words)**
9. Discuss the distinctive features of Sangam literature and its value as a historical source. **(250 words)**
10. "*Technological advances in early historic India raised agricultural output but deepened social stratification.*" Examine. **(150 words)**

### **Self-check (out loud, no notes):**

- Name the three Tamil social groups and the three northern ones, in order of status.
- List the three Sangam kingdoms with capital, port and emblem.
- Name four things found at Arikamedu that prove Roman trade.
- What did Hippalus discover, and why did it matter?
- Give five differences between Gandhara and Mathura art.
- What was a *shreni*, and name four things it did?
- Which pilgrim came under which ruler?